Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	$323.36 ▲ 0.87%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$365.00	$267.67 – $408.61	$3.95T

GOOGL: Quiet Grind Higher Ahead of Earnings, Antitrust Overhang Lifting

WHAT HAPPENED

- GOOGL quietly ground back to $323 after a mid-week dip to $316 — nothing dramatic, just a stock consolidating ahead of earnings (Oct 29). The fact that it's holding up while sitting at only 40% of its 52-week range tells me buyers are stepping in on dips, not panicking.
- Options flow is leaning bullish — the put/call ratio of 0.55 means traders are buying almost 2x more calls (bets the stock goes up) than puts (bets it falls). Someone bought 8,200 call contracts at the $360 strike, which is a bet the stock pops into year-end.

WHY IT MATTERS

This is a "coiled spring" setup — the stock is drifting in a tight range right before earnings, which usually means a bigger move is coming one way or the other. The bullish options positioning combined with heavy institutional ownership (81%) suggests the smart money thinks the risk/reward skews up, likely because expectations for Cloud and Gemini monetization have been reset lower after the summer's AI capex panic. Politically, the DOJ's antitrust remedy phase has been landing softer than feared (behavioral remedies vs. a Chrome breakup), which removes a huge overhang — every month that passes without a forced divestiture is a month the market can re-rate this stock higher. The thing to watch: if Alphabet guides capex up again, the stock could sell off initially even on good numbers, because the market is still twitchy about AI spending ROI.

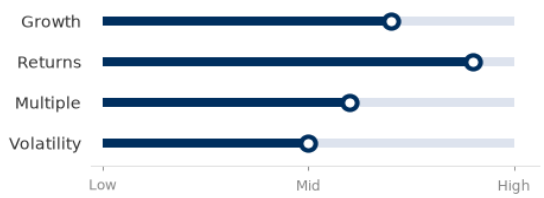
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one is the DOJ antitrust remedy ruling — the judge has signaled he's unlikely to force a Chrome spinoff, which was the nightmare scenario. Instead, we're looking at data-sharing requirements and limits on default search deals (like the Apple payment), which hurts margins at the edges but doesn't blow up the business model. Also watch the EU AI Act enforcement kicking in — Alphabet is one of the few players with the compliance infrastructure ready, which is actually a moat against smaller AI startups who can't afford the legal overhead. On the US side, any movement on the bipartisan "AI Leadership Act" being floated in the Senate would be a tailwind — it includes federal procurement preferences for domestic AI providers, and GCP is well positioned to grab share.

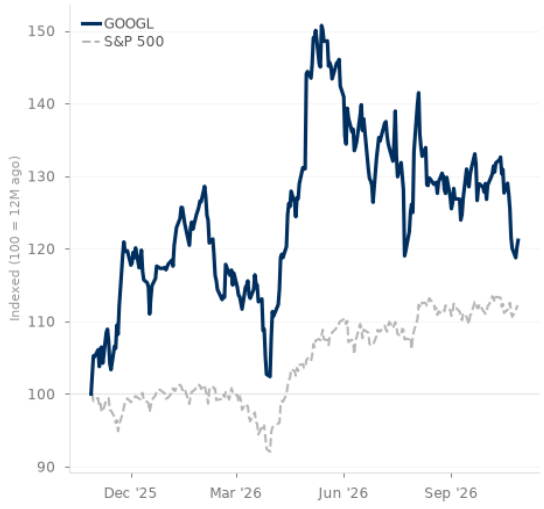
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data	
Price (USD)	**$323.36**
12M Price Target	**$365.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+12.9%**
Market Cap	**$3.95T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$408M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$462M**
FY2026E EPS	**$9.85**
FY2027E EPS	**$11.40**
Fwd P/E	**32.8x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

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PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$345.00**	$330.00	**$305.00**
6 Months	**$380.00**	$350.00	**$285.00**
1 Year	**$420.00**	$365.00	**$270.00**
2 Years	**$500.00**	$420.00	**$260.00**
5 Years	**$700.00**	$550.00	**$240.00**
10 Years	**$1100.00**	$800.00	**$300.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+0.92%) is leading — likely a mix of Middle East tension premium and the administration's permitting push for LNG exports. Healthcare also catching a bid as the drug pricing executive order fears fade.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Staples (-0.31%) — classic "risk-on" tell, money leaving defensive names. Industrials flat as tariff uncertainty lingers.

ROTATION WATCH: Tech is quietly green (+0.73% over 5 days) with money concentrating in the mega-cap AI names rather than spreading across the sector — that's a GOOGL tailwind because it's one of the preferred vehicles for AI exposure at a reasonable price.

RELATED PLAY: If Alphabet's Cloud numbers surprise to the upside, the picks-and-shovels names benefit — think data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) and power infrastructure plays (VST, CEG) that supply the electricity to run these AI farms.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- META (Meta Platforms): Riding the same AI monetization wave as GOOGL but with less antitrust overhang — ad business firing on all cylinders.
- MSFT (Microsoft): Enterprise AI adoption via Copilot keeps grinding higher, benchmark for what GOOGL's Workspace AI could become.

GOOGL CONTEXT: Alphabet has been a laggard in the mega-cap AI trade this year — sitting at only 40% of its 52-week range while peers are near highs. That lag is exactly the opportunity: either GOOGL catches up (my base case) or the whole AI trade cools and everything mean-reverts. The setup favors the catch-up trade going into earnings.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: $305-315 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Cloud growth decelerates below 25% or DOJ forces Chrome/Android divestiture

Hedging: Small put spread into earnings or pair with short MSFT

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